

Some days, I genuinely look good.

I'll look in the mirror and think, damn, I've actually got my shit together. I'll smile, joke around, play the game, talk to people, and from the outside, you'd probably think I'm doing perfectly fine.

But looks can be deceiving.

Because there are days where I go home, everything gets quiet, and I feel the weight of things I don't talk about. Losing someone you thought would stay. Wondering what you could've done differently. Replaying conversations in your head and asking yourself where it all went wrong.

And the hardest part is that nobody can really see it.

You can be hurting and still make people laugh.

You can miss somebody and never text them.

You can feel completely lost and still show up the next morning like nothing happened.

That's something I've learned about life: pain doesn't always look like pain.

Sometimes it looks like a guy with a smile on his face, headphones on, playing games for hours because it's easier to focus on a screen than your own thoughts.

But eventually, you have to understand something.

Not every person you love is meant to stay. Not every relationship is supposed to work. And not every loss means you failed.

Sometimes people come into your life, change you, leave a piece of themselves behind, and then become a chapter you carry instead of a person you hold.

And yeah, some days that hurts like hell.

But you keep going.

Not because you're never sad.

Not because you suddenly stop caring.

Not because everything magically gets better.

You keep going because your story doesn't end at the part that broke your heart.

One bad relationship isn't your whole life.

One lonely night isn't your future.

One person walking away doesn't mean you're unworthy of being loved.

So if you're hurting right now, even if nobody knows it, keep pushing.

Take the loss. Learn from it. Feel it. Cry if you need to.

Then get up tomorrow.

Because maybe the point of life isn't to never get hurt.

Maybe it's learning that you can get hurt, lose people, lose pieces of yourself, and still somehow find a reason to keep moving forward.

And sometimes, that's what being strong actually looks like.